

Deepfake PSA



2 hours



Grades 11 - 12



Press release

Government & economics



Self-guided

The Point

AI-generated deepfakes have recently emerged as a potential source of fake news with serious repercussions for established political systems. With carefully calibrated communication, civic leaders can prepare the public for ways in which deepfakes might influence their perspective.

Objectives

- Explain how deepfakes are created, identified, and prevented
- Develop fact-based, balanced written communications aimed at the general public.

Materials

- Internet-enabled devices for students
- Access to the [Student Guide](#) for students
- Access to the [Press Release Template](#)

Activities

Make sure students have access to the [Student Guide](#).

1. **Discuss** the warmup question with students as they try to figure out which image is fake. Ask students why they made their choice. **(5 min.)**
2. **Review** the [AI in 5 Minutes](#) website page and the definitions of "deepfake" and "press release" with students **(5 min.)**
3. **Direct** students to review the "Deepfakes and Democracy" section of the Student Guide and watch [Deep Fakes: How They're Made and How They Can Be Detected](#) **(12 min.)**
 - a. **Ask:** "What is one way deepfakes can have a positive impact on democracy and what is one way they can have a negative impact?"
4. **Direct** students to read the "What makes a good press release?" section of the Student Guide **(20 min.)**
5. **Review** students' reactions to the two press release examples **(10 min.)**
 - a. **Ask:** "Which press release is more effective? Why?"
6. **Direct** students to plan their press release using the "Press Release Outline" section in the Student Guide **(15 min.)**

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Activities, continued

7. **Direct** students to write their own deepfake press release using the [Press Release Template](#) and following the guidelines in the Student Guide (45 min.)
 - Every press release should:
 - Be between 250 - 400 words
 - Have a clear and descriptive headline
 - Clearly explain who, what, where, why, and when
 - Have an introduction and conclusion
 - Include at least one quotation
8. **Debrief** with the class by asking students "do you think this press release would make a big difference in combating fake news? Why or why not?" (8 min.)

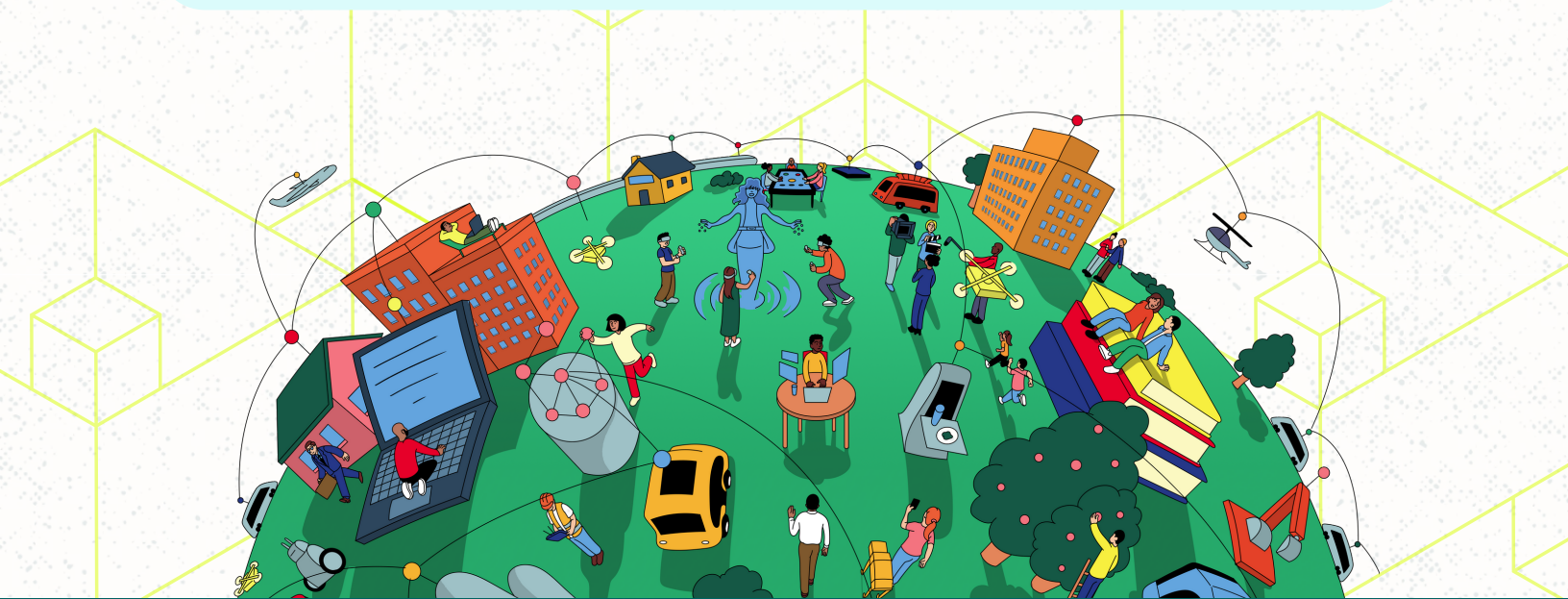
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